MACHIATTO: Advanced Design Proposal

A Multiversal Narrative Card Game

FUNDAMENTAL CONCEPT

Machiatto is a revolutionary collectible card game that transforms the traditional combat experience into a dynamic narrative construction. Each game represents a story that unfolds through the cards played, where players are not simply opponents, but co-narrators of an emergent tale seeking to reach a satisfying conclusion.

CENTRAL NARRATIVE STRUCTURE

The Narrative Arc as Main Mechanic

Unlike Raw Deal or Magic, where the objective is to reduce opponent resources, Machiatto is structured around the concept of "Narrative Arc." Each player tries to build a coherent narrative arc that culminates in a powerful and satisfying "Ending."

Components of the Narrative Arc:

1. **Exposition** - Initial phase where characters and settings are established
2. **Development** - Building phase where conflicts and situations are generated
3. **Climax** - Intensification phase where culminating moments are reached
4. **Resolution** - Final phase where the narrative is closed with an Ending

RESOURCE SYSTEM: NARRATIVE POTENTIAL

"Narrative Potential" (NP) replaces Raw Deal's Fortitude, but with a crucial difference: it represents not only power, but narrative complexity and emotional depth.

- Each player starts with NP = 0
- Successfully played cards increase NP according to their "Narrative Value" (NV)
- NP determines what level of cards can be played
- Unlike Raw Deal, NP can fluctuate during the game according to narrative turns

CARD TYPES

1. Character Cards (Deep Blue)

Represent the protagonists, antagonists, and secondary characters of the story. - **Subtype: Protagonist** - Establishes the main narrative tone - **Subtype: Antagonist** - Creates tension and conflict - **Subtype: Secondary** - Provides support and development

2. Setting Cards (Emerald Green)

Establish the spatial and temporal context where the action takes place. - **Subtype: Location** - Physical places - **Subtype: Atmosphere** - Environmental or emotional conditions - **Subtype: Era** - Temporal context

3. Event Cards (Crimson Red)

Represent actions, occurrences, and happenings that drive the narrative. - **Subtype: Action** - Events initiated by characters - **Subtype: Incident** - External events that affect characters - **Subtype: Revelation** - Discoveries that change perception

4. Twist Cards (Purple)

Unexpectedly alter the course of the narrative. - **Subtype: Plot Twist** - Drastic changes in the direction of the story - **Subtype: Flashback** - Revelations from the past that affect the present - **Subtype: Foreshadowing** - Hints of future events

5. Interruption Cards (Orange)

Similar to reversals in Raw Deal, but with narrative justification. - **Subtype: Counter-twist** - Neutralizes a narrative twist - **Subtype: Deus Ex Machina** - Unexpected solution to an apparently impossible problem - **Subtype: Subversion** - Contradicts established expectations

6. Ending Cards (Gold)

The equivalent to Finishers, represent narrative conclusions. - **Subtype: Epic** - Grand and spectacular endings - **Subtype: Intimate** - Emotional and personal endings - **Subtype: Open** - Endings that suggest continuation

INNOVATIVE MECHANICS

1. Narrative Coherence System

Unlike Raw Deal where any card can be played if the Fortitude requirement is met, Machiatto introduces the concept of "Narrative Coherence." Cards must not only meet the NP requirement but must make sense in the established narrative context.

Implementation: - Each card has "Narrative Tags" (genre, tone, theme) - Playing cards with coherent tags grants NP bonuses - Playing incoherent cards generates "Narrative Dissonance" (penalty)

2. Parallel Arcs

Players can develop multiple narrative lines simultaneously.

Implementation: - The board is divided into "Narrative Threads" (maximum 3) - Each Thread can develop its own arc - Threads can converge for more powerful effects - Allows "interwoven narrative" strategies

3. Dynamic Climax System

Climax is not a static value like Fortitude, but a resource that fluctuates according to narrative tension.

Implementation: - Event and Twist cards increase Climax - Climax can decrease with Interruptions or moments of calm - Extreme Climax levels (very high or very low) allow special effects - Endings require specific Climax levels to be played

4. Multiversal Resonance

Mechanic that allows interactions between different genres and narrative universes.

Implementation: - Cards with the "Nexus" characteristic can connect different genres - "Convergence Points" allow special effects when disparate elements are combined - "Narrative Echo" system where similar themes resonate between different universes

VICTORY CONDITIONS

Machiatto offers multiple paths to victory, all centered on narrative:

1. Victory by Satisfying Ending

- Play an Ending that meets specific Coherence and Climax requirements
- The Ending must resolve key elements introduced during the game

- The more elements it resolves, the more powerful the effect

2. Victory by Superior Narrative

- Accumulate "Narrative Impact Points" (NIP) throughout the game
- NIPs are obtained through coherence, creativity, and memorable moments
- Upon reaching a threshold (typically 20-25 NIP), victory is achieved

3. Victory by Opponent Dissonance

- Force the opponent to create an incoherent narrative
- If the opponent's "Narrative Dissonance" reaches a critical level, their story collapses
- Similar to deck depletion in Raw Deal, but with narrative justification

GENRES AND ARCHETYPES SYSTEM

Machiatto organizes its cards not by arbitrary colors but by narrative genres:

Main Genres:

- **Science Fiction** - Focused on technology, future, and exploration
- **Fantasy** - Centered on magic, mythical creatures, and imaginary worlds
- **Horror** - Based on fear, suspense, and the supernatural
- **Romance** - Focused on relationships, emotions, and personal connections
- **Adventure** - Centered on exploration, discovery, and overcoming challenges
- **Drama** - Based on personal conflicts and moral dilemmas

Each genre has its own archetypes, tropes, and conventions that influence mechanics:

Example: Horror vs. Romance - Horror cards generate more Climax but less Coherence - Romance cards generate more Coherence but require more preparation - A Horror Ending can win by shock, while a Romance one by emotional satisfaction

DECK BUILDING

1. Basic Structure

- 60 main cards (as in Raw Deal)
- 1 "Premise" card (equivalent to Superstar)
- Up to 15 "Subplot" cards (similar to Backlash Deck)

2. The Premise Card

Defines the general tone and grants special abilities: - Establishes the main genre - Provides a unique ability - Determines the "Narrative Inclination" (equivalent to Face/Heel)

3. Thematic Restrictions

Unlike Raw Deal where restrictions are mechanical, in Machiatto they are narrative: - Maximum 70% of cards from a single genre - At least 3 Characters for each Ending in the deck - Coherence between Premise and deck composition

CARD EXAMPLES

Character Card:

Tormented Detective (Noir/Drama) - Narrative Value: 3 - NP Requirement: 2 - Effect: "When it enters play, reveal the top card of your opponent's deck. If it's an Event or Twist, increase your NP by 2." - Tags: Investigation, Mystery, Internal Conflict

Event Card:

Alien Invasion (Science Fiction) - Narrative Value: 8 - NP Requirement: 15 - Effect: "Increase Climax by 5. All current Settings acquire the 'Chaos' tag. Characters without the 'Adaptable' tag reduce their effect by half." - Tags: Catastrophe, Global, Advanced Technology

Ending Card:

Heroic Sacrifice (Multiple Genres) - Narrative Value: 12 - NP Requirement: 25 - Climax Requirement: 20+ - Effect: "Choose a Protagonist Character. Remove it from the game. You win the game if you have played at least 3 Events that directly affected that Character during the game." - Tags: Redemption, Tragedy, Heroism

GAME DYNAMICS

Turn Sequence

1. **Inspiration Phase** - Draw card(s)
2. **Development Phase** - Play cards to advance the narrative
3. **Reflection Phase** - Activate special effects and adjust resources
4. **Anticipation Phase** - Prepare elements for the next turn

Player Interaction

Unlike Raw Deal where interaction is primarily antagonistic, Machiatto encourages more complex interaction: - **Competitive Collaboration** - Players can benefit from opponent's narrative elements - **Narrative Subversion** - Interrupt or redirect opponent's narrative - **Interweaving** - Create connections between both narratives for special effects

TECHNICAL INNOVATIONS FOR 2025

1. Augmented Reality System

- Cards with AR markers that come to life when scanned
- Visualization of key scenes and narrative moments
- Visual effects representing Coherence and Climax

2. Companion Application

- Automatic tracking of NP, Climax, and Coherence
- Generation of narrative summaries of the game
- Deck building suggestions based on thematic coherence

3. Narrative Community

- Platform for sharing memorable "stories" (games)
- Voting system for the best emergent narratives
- Tournaments based not only on victories but on narrative quality

EXPANSIONS AND LICENSES

The system is designed to easily incorporate existing IPs:

Example: "Marvel Universe" Expansion

- Characters, settings, and events from the MCU
- Special mechanics reflecting Marvel's narrative style
- Possibility of crossover with other IPs through Nexus cards

Example: "Literary Classics" Expansion

- Characters and settings from famous literary works
- Focus on more complex narratives and deeper themes
- Interaction with modern elements to create interesting contrasts

CONCLUSION

Machiatto represents a revolutionary evolution of collectible card games, transforming competition into collaborative narration without sacrificing strategic depth. By merging elements of Raw Deal with a sophisticated narrative structure, it creates a unique experience where each game tells a memorable story.

The true innovation of Machiatto lies in its ability to adapt proven mechanics to a new paradigm where the goal is not to destroy but to create, not to defeat but to impress, not to dominate but to express. In a market saturated with combat games, Machiatto offers a refreshing alternative that attracts both traditional players and new audiences interested in narrative and creativity.